

Afterward

The calls after a death, made for you.

One conversation with the family. Then a voice agent phones every bank, insurer, utility and pension — waits on hold, says it's an AI, and brings back a verified case reference and a recording for every account.

The government automated its half. The family got the phone calls.

"You'll also need to tell organisations outside government, like employers and private pension providers, banks, and utility companies."

GOV.UK — WHAT TO DO AFTER SOMEONE DIES (VERIFIED SEP 2026)

Tell Us Once

covers government departments. Nothing else.

DNS

the Death Notification Service covers member banks. Nothing else.

Everyone else

answers the phone — a dozen calls, queues, the death retold each time, in the worst week of a family's life.

One conversation. Twelve calls. Evidence for each.

A

Afterward

The boardEstate LedgerGitHub

Estate of Margaret Rose Holt

Executor: Daniel Holt (son) · died 13 September 2026 · the family does **not** have account or policy numbers

SIMULATED TEST BED — 12 FICTIONAL INSTITUTIONS · REPLAYING REAL CAPTURED VOICE AGENT SESSIONS · HOLDS COMPRESSED ×8 · RUNNING

Averley Water

UTILITY

● SPEAKING

LINE To report a leak or a supply problem, press one. For a bereavement or a change of occupier, ...

LINE Occupier services, Janet here. I'm so sorry for your loss. May I take the name of the accoun...

NO CASE YET

Ashdown Home Insurance

INSURER

● SPEAKING

AFTERWARD

LINE Hello, you're through to Poppy. I understand you're calling about a bereavement — I'm so sor...

NO CASE YET

Brindle Broadband

TELECOM

● SPEAKING

AFTERWARD

LINE Hello there, Niamh speaking on the customer care desk. I believe you're calling about a bere...

NO CASE YET

Caledonia Life

INSURER

● SPEAKING

AFTERWARD Thank you, Alan. The deceased is Margaret Rose Holt, H O L T, and she passed away on the thi...

Foxglove TV

TELECOM

● SPEAKING

AFTERWARD Thank you, Cormac. The member was Margaret Rose Holt, H-O-L-T, and she passed away on the thi...

Kestrel Mobile

TELECOM

● SPEAKING

AFTERWARD <thought >

LINE Hiya, you're through to Dara at Kestrel. I can see you've come through...

EVENT LOG

→ Pennard Card Services: agent

→ press_key

→ Wessex Building Society: agent

→ press_key

→ Silverbeck Pensions: agent

→ press_key

→ Netherfield District Council: agent

→ press_key

REFUSED Harberton & Vale Bank:

REFUSED — reference mismatch, agent re-asks

→ Harberton & Vale Bank: agent → record_outcome

→ Harberton & Vale Bank: agent

→ press_key

→ Kestrel Mobile: agent → press_key

→ Northgate Energy: agent → press_key

Solution — the live board (replaying real captured sessions)

03 / 10

Doctrine, not features

It never guesses

A server-side validator checks every reference against what the clerk actually said. Wrong captures are refused mid-call and re-asked. Anything the family didn't provide becomes an amber "Needs you" card. There is no code path that invents a value.

It says it's an AI

Every call opens with a disclosure that an AI assistant is calling with the family's permission — required by EU AI Act Art. 50 (in force 2 Aug 2026), and by decency first.

Evidence for everything

Every call ends with a stereo recording (institution left, agent right), a timeline, and a verified reference in a shareable Estate Ledger.

Measured, not claimed

12

CALLS MADE, FULL-LENGTH HOLDS

12

REFERENCES VERIFIED VS GROUND TRUTH

9m 47s

OF HOLD ENDURED

0

UNVERIFIED WRITES, EVER

2

ESCALATED TO THE FAMILY, NOT GUESSED

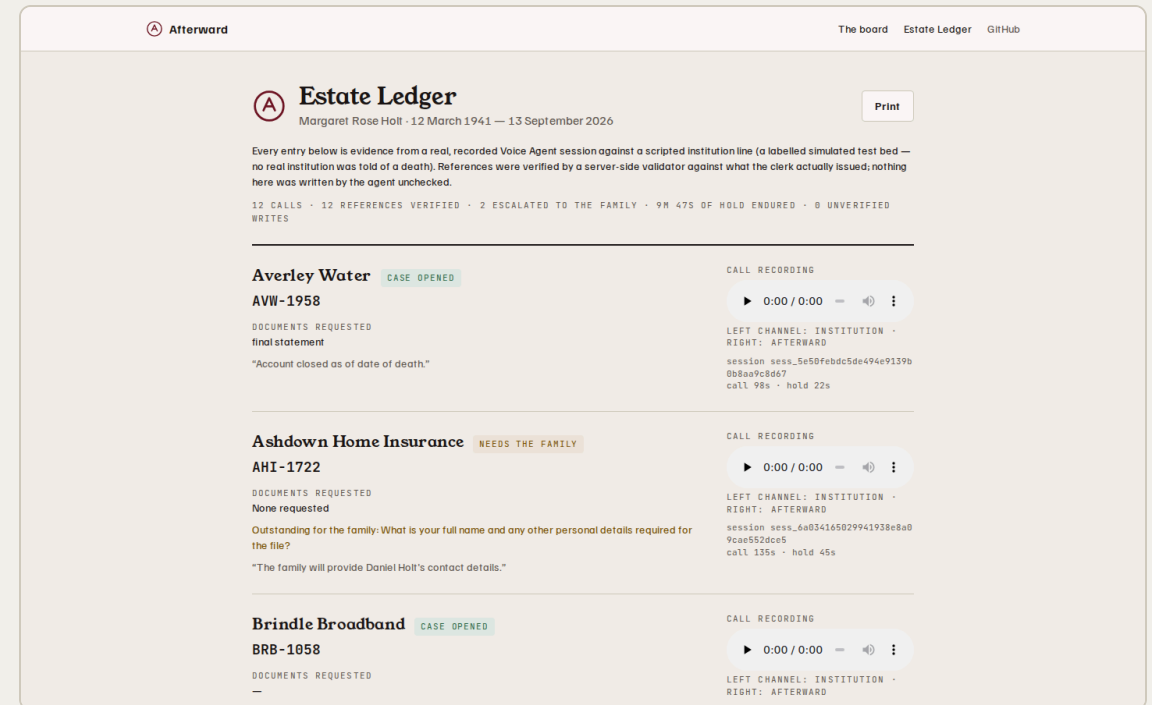
1

VALIDATOR REFUSALS, ALL RECOVERED

SEEDED ESTATE · 12 SCRIPTED INSTITUTION LINES (LABELLED SIMULATED TEST BED) · REPRODUCE WITH NPM RUN VERIFY

Deep in the Voice Agent API

- One live Voice Agent session per call — STT, turn detection, TTS, tools in one WebSocket
- Client-side tools: `press_key` (DTMF), `flag_needs_family`, `record_outcome` — with a validator that can refuse
- `transcription_mode` → `max_accuracy` switched mid-call, right before the reference is spoken
- Per-call keyterms for the deceased's name — never the expected reference (no ground-truth biasing)
- Sponsor-side stereo recordings (left = institution, right = agent) are the Ledger's evidence
- Turn-taking survives scripted IVR menus, hold music and a 6-bit degraded-audio failure hunt



Market

650k

UK DEATHS / YEAR

2.8M

US DEATHS / YEAR

30-60

ORGANISATIONS TO NOTIFY PER ESTATE

Every death creates days of notification work. Funeral directors already sell aftercare and compete on service; estate solicitors bill for this by the hour. The category is proven — Empathy has raised ~\$90M, Settld partners with UK banks — and both stop at forms and email. The phone call is the unautomated last mile.

Nobody makes the calls

	Coverage	Mechanism	Evidence trail
Tell Us Once (gov)	Government only	One form	—
Death Notification Service	Member banks only	Web form → banks call the family back	—
Empathy / Settld	Broad	Forms, email, human ops	Status updates
Afterward	Everyone with a phone line	Makes the call — holds, menus, clerks	Verified reference + recording per account

Afterward files Tell Us Once and DNS where they exist — and phones everyone they don't cover.

Business model & roadmap

REVENUE

- **B2B (primary):** funeral directors' aftercare packages — per-case licence, existing budget line, built-in distribution at the moment of need
- **B2B:** estate & probate firms — per-matter, the Ledger drops straight into the file
- **B2C:** per-estate, one price, unlimited institutions

NEXT 90 DAYS

- Real outbound leg (Twilio SIP ↔ Voice Agent API) — starting with requirements-discovery calls to real bereavement lines: "what do you need from a family?" — legitimate, harms no one, maps the terrain
- Institution requirements directory built from those calls
- Tell Us Once + DNS filing; document upload & tracking

Honest limits: green means what a first human call achieves – case opened, documents requested. Never "done". The demo institutions are simulated and say so on screen; calling a real bank with a fictional death would be fraud, so we refuse to demo it.

LIVE

afterward-lablab.vercel.app

CODE (MIT)

github.com/itssaharsh/afterward